

The 2016/2017 season can be attest as one of the most successful seasons for the North Canterbury children's athletic club history. The club welcomed on board to the coaching staff Jo Ramsay. Under Jo's guidance the young athletes performances steadily built up and peaking towards the end of the season where each week there were numerous personal bests bettered. One weekend there was 15 PB's at Rawhiti. The children were very fortunate to have Jo at the Colgate games to warm them up and talk race strategies. One athlete was heard saying to her race rivals that the North Canterbury coach warms them up all before their races and jumping events.

The club would like to thank Rodney Philips for his throw coaching and Alley Hendren for jump coaching and all the other parents who helped out throughout the season.

Without these people the club training nights would not run as smoothly.

Denise Pawsey was again a driving force in organising registrations, uniforms, the weekly club trainings and weekend competitions plus many more activities. Thank you Denise for all your tiresome hard work through out the season.

There were 29 registered athletes and many paying weekly athletes. It was great to see some of the non registered athletes doing well at the Canterbury primary schools champs in Ashburton. Next season the club is going to revisit the training night programme that integrates registered and non registered members.

Thankyou to our sponsors Main power for sweat shirts, Trust Aoraki for funding towards our new singlets. This year we were able to purchase a new High Jump mat from a grant through the Rata Foundation.

The season ends with a new trophy in the cabinet - Jeannette Vivian Memorial Trophy. This is for the highest average points for a club at the Colgate games for grade 10 and higher.

This years colgate games held in Invercargill can be described as a raving success.

There were 4 gold medals won Ben Philips 2 Jess Hendren 1 Lillie Rayer 1. 5 Silver Mya Philips 1, Lillie Rayner 2, Aaron Reavil 1, 12 year old girls rely team. 1 Bronze Jess Hendren. Along with these athletes Emma Pawsey, Dylan Butler and Kaitlyn Feather also had further top ten placings.

At the season's final event the Canterbury champs held in Timaru, saw another stack of personal bests achieved. Again under the watchful eye of Jo, who was keep busy warming up and cooling down competitors. There were many top three placings by North Canterbury athletes. Jess Hendren and Dylan Bulter both placed third over all in the under 11 grades.

The high light for some (apart from the adult relays) was the top placing of the 12 year old girls rely team going one better than the Colgate games to win. Congrates to Emma Pawsey, Kaitlyn Feather, Lillie Rayner and Jess Hendren for a heart stopping race.

Following on from the seasons strong performances Ben Philips, Kaitlyn Feather and Lillie Rayner have been selected for the Canterbury Inter provincial team.

Jess Hendren, Dylan Butler, Aaron Reavil, Mya Philips and Chelsea Reavil have also been selected for the Canterbury try series to be held in Dunedin.

As the season draws to a end we can safely say we are ending the season on a high. Thank you to a awesome group of parents, athletes and Jo, for making this year amazing and fun.